



Tandy Corporation/Radio Shack

News Release

For Release:

For Further Information: August 3, 1987

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RS-87-003

RADIO SHACK ANNOUNCES NEW PRODUCTS ON TENTH ANNIVERSARY OF THEIR FIRST PERSONAL COMPUTER

NEW YORK, NY - In a "Nationwide Anniversary Celebration", today, personal computer pioneer Radio Shack unveiled four new and two upgraded PC-compatible Tandy® computers, plus three new printers, giving the company the industry's most extensive line of personal computers. The new computers are additions to Tandy's line. No existing models have been discontinued. Also introduced were two new cellular telephone models. The Waldorf-Astoria press conference was satellite-linked to Dallas, Texas and Anaheim, California, where more than 1600 Radio Shack® managers were attending annual meetings of the company's business products and western consumer divisions.

Tandy President, CEO, and Chairman John V. Roach expressed Tandy's commitment to product value, unique technologically innovative products, and providing compatibility with existing and future operating systems, user-interface and connectivity environments and applications software. He spoke of key strategic directions including simplification of computer use and a "building block" selection of system configuration options.

Stating, "The 80386 is now an affordable option for all users," Roach introduced the new Tandy® 4000 personal computer. This 16Mhz, 80386-based PC, priced at \$2,599, uses software based

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on the latest MS-DOS® and UNIX® operating systems, and is "OS/2® ready" for future applications. The 4000 comes with one 3.5-inch 1.44-megabyte (Mb) floppy disk drive. Two additional storage device slots let the buyer choose the options needed from a broad range of 3.5-inch and 5.25-inch floppies, hard disks, and internal cartridge or tape backup systems.

Also included are nine expansion slots, 1Mb RAM (expandable to 16Mb), serial and parallel ports, and keylock. Currently-owned and widely available expansion options are supported through two "XT™" and six "AT®"-compatible slots. One 32-bit slot is dedicated to memory expansion.

The popular 80286-based Tandy® 3000 computer received a speed increase to 12 Mhz, a keylock/chassis locking system, and a lower price of \$1,999. At \$1,499, the lowest priced of Tandy's "OS/2 Ready", 80286-based 3000 family is the Tandy® 3000 HL computer. It now includes a 101-key enhanced keyboard, and keylock system.

Roach revealed reliability statistics (held in confidence by most manufacturers) for Tandy's 3000 family, which included a calculated Mean Time Between Failure (MTBF) of over 58,000 hours, and end user out-of-box failure rate of less than one percent.

Roach announced a new Professional DeskMate™ integrated software product scheduled for bundling with Tandy 3000 operating system options in the fourth quarter of this year. It will be available for other PC-compatible products as well. This new

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version of a Tandy-designed favorite uses pull-down menus, pop-up dialogue boxes, and features mouse, joystick or simple keyboard control. New and considerably enhanced features have been tailored specifically to office use.

The most significant change is a utility called DeskLink™ which allows small workgroups to share a common calendar, phone directory, an electronic mail system, file transfers, and even share a printer. Connectivity options range from a simple RS-232 cable for two users, to sophisticated networks such as the one Radio Shack offers from 3-Com Corporation.

Available along with the Professional DeskMate software will be a very low-cost network hardware interface called TandyLink™. This "twisted-pair" system is ideal for connecting Professional DeskMate workgroups. TandyLink is not only compatible with the AppleTalk® network system but can run three times faster than their normal speed. Delivering on the company's promise to make networking simple enough for everyone, these products provide a "plug in and go" workgroup system, requiring no special training or expert user to install, implement and use.

The company's entry into the PC-compatible laptop market, the new Tandy® 1400 LT computer answers a common MS-DOS laptop complaint of short battery life by providing a unique, removable rechargeable battery pack. The \$1,599 unit is based on a high-performance NEC V-20 microprocessor and features the latest high-contrast "backlit supertwist" liquid crystal display

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technology, two 3.5-inch 720-kilobyte (Kb) disk drives, and 768Kb memory. Additional standard features include 76-key keyboard, real time clock, parallel and serial ports, input socket for a 101-key enhanced keyboard, and outputs for RGBI and composite video monitors.

Two additions to Tandy's best-selling 1000 family were shown. Operating at three times the speed of IBM's latest PS/2 Model 30, and over six times the speed of the PC/XT, the new \$1,199 Tandy® 1000 TX computer brings 80286 speed to the PC/XT market. The TX comes with 640Kb memory, one 3.5-inch 720Kb floppy drive plus one open drive slot, joystick, serial and parallel ports, enhanced CGA graphics, three-voice sound, headphone jack and volume control, MS-DOS and GW-BASIC® software, and a new enhanced version of Tandy's DeskMate® 2 program. The Tandy 1000 TX computer offers unmatched speed and value in a low-cost, American-made brand name PC.

Citing Tandy's commitment to superior value, Roach announced a move rarely seen in the PC industry - a technology upgrade for existing products. Owners of existing Tandy 1000 computers will be offered an accessory 80286 board which replaces their original 8088 processor for faster performance.

The Tandy 1000 HX computer is a truly functional one-drive PC-compatible, designed to provide a new dimension in ease of use, without any sacrifice in performance. Tandy executives say the \$699 HX's unique features represent more technology per

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dollar than any other MS-DOS computer can claim. The MS-DOS operating system is contained in read only memory (ROM), eliminating the need for an ever-present MS-DOS disk.

The HX also features an Electrically Erasable Programmable (by the user) Read Only Memory (EEPROM), which stores system configuration and user-selected start-up information, for "Power and Run" operation. The user can specify processor speed, an external drive as the primary drive, immediate power-on execution of the Personal DeskMate 2™ program, a utility menu, or a selected application program (in lieu of DOS). A user never has to see the MS-DOS "A>" prompt or worry with switch-selected configuration options.

Students can insert a program disk, turn the power on, and see their lesson on-screen with no intermediate steps... a unique capability available in no other personal computer system.

Supplied with one 3.5-inch 720Kb drive, the HX will accept a second 3.5-inch internal drive, and an external 5.25-inch drive. Standard memory is 256Kb, expandable to 640Kb.

Portions of Personal DeskMate 2 are included in ROM for fast operation. The HX also includes printer and joystick ports, three-voice sound, headphone jack and volume control, plus enhanced CGA graphics.

Enhanced Personal DeskMate 2 software is included with the Tandy 1000 TX and 1000 HX personal computers. Especially when used with a mouse, it brings a graphics-oriented user interface -

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rivaling the best available today, yet in color - to low-cost PC compatible computers. This multi-function software product takes advantage of the 1000 family's "enhanced" CGA graphics.

Simplified keyboard control of pull-down menus and pop-up dialogue boxes has been added, along with a music composition program. Also, "Paint" is expanded from four to 16 colors. Cursor control options include mouse, joystick, or keyboard.

To fully implement low-cost desktop publishing based on Tandy's 3000 family and new 4000, the company introduced the LP 1000, a \$2,199 laser printer. The unit features full-page (1.5Mb) memory and on-board controller, and produces six pages per minute in Tandy, IBM®, and HP LaserJet Plus®-compatible modes, with 300 x 300 dot-per-inch resolution.

Two new dot-matrix printers were shown. The DMP 2120 is a \$1,599, PC-compatible, 240 character per second letter-quality printer with color ribbon option. A 24-wire print head can produce a variety of internal or downloaded fonts. A push-type "zero tear" tractor is supplied.

The DMP 440 is a 300 character per second, PC-compatible nine-wire 132-column printer, selling for \$699. It also accepts downloaded fonts in addition to those supplied.

Included in the announcement were two new Radio Shack cellular telephones, giving the company three versatile models.

The CT-300 portable cellular telephone is an ultra-small, battery-powered, hand-held unit no larger than many cordless

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phones. Advanced features include 40-number memory, one-button re-dial, dial lock, and lighted LCD multi-function display. The CT-300 is supplied with built-in rechargeable battery pack, portable antenna, carrying case and strap, for \$1,499.

The new CT-100 phone is a low-cost, feature-rich mobile unit delivering full 3-watt performance. Complete with handset, speaker and visor microphone, the CT-100 retails for \$799.

An improved version of Radio Shack's popular 3-watt Transportable Cellular Telephone (mobile mount or battery-operated portable) continues at \$1,199. (Portable adapter and batteries optional.)

Prices apply at Radio Shack stores, Radio Shack Computer Centers® and participating dealers nationwide. Tandy is the largest selling brand of PC-compatible personal computers in North American retail computer channels.

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